

Supplier Communications & Intelligence Program

A structured framework for supplier accountability, data integrity, and scalable communication across a global supply base.

PROGRAM MANAGEMENT · DATA GOVERNANCE · ESCALATION · LEADERSHIP REPORTING

Without Structure, Supply Chains Break Down

Scattered Outreach

- Multiple teams contact the same suppliers
- Duplicate or conflicting requests

Zero Visibility

- No central view of responses
- Escalations get lost in inboxes

Unreliable Data

- Inconsistent or missing supplier data
- Contact info decays by ~15% per year

No Leadership Insight

- No clear performance answer
- Reporting requires manual spreadsheets

Result

Compliance risk, reactive firefighting, and no scalable way to manage hundreds of supplier relationships.

Six Pillars of the Program

Campaign Design

Define what to ask, who to ask, when, and how often for each supplier engagement type.

Supplier Tracking

Know exactly who responded, who is pending, and who needs escalation in real time.

Data Integrity

Maintain accurate contact records with clear governance, verification, and audit routines.

Leadership Reporting

Deliver response dashboards, trend analysis, and executive summaries from live data.

Escalation Management

Run structured follow-up workflows with clear triggers, ownership, and audit trail.

Cross-Functional Alignment

Keep sourcing, compliance, operations, quality, IT, and finance aligned on a shared cadence.

Step 1: Supplier Prioritization

Simchi-Levi Risk Exposure Index

$REI = \text{Time to Recover} - \text{Time to Survive}$

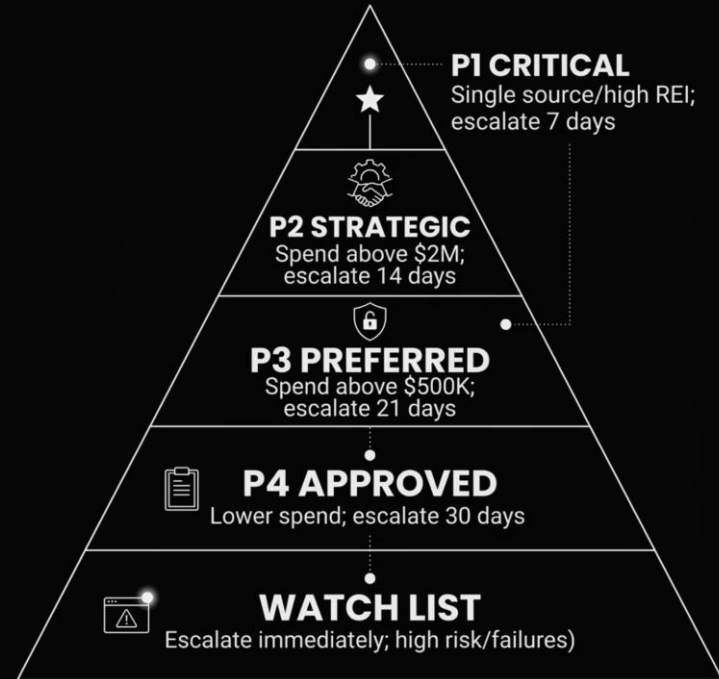
Time to Recover: time needed to restore normal operations after a disruption

Time to Survive: maximum time a business can operate without that supplier

Positive REI indicates critical risk and higher prioritization.

Composite score factors:

- Single source flag 25%
- Annual spend 20%
- Financial risk flag 10%
- Performance history 10%



Step 2: Four Campaign Types

1

Regulatory Compliance

Quarterly and annual

CO₂ emissions, CBAM certificates, conflict minerals, RoHS, REACH

2

Risk & Financial Health

Annual

REI inputs, TTR/TTS estimates, financial health, business continuity plans, sub-tier visibility

3

Performance & Corrective Action

Event-triggered

Root cause analysis, corrective action plans, evidence of measures

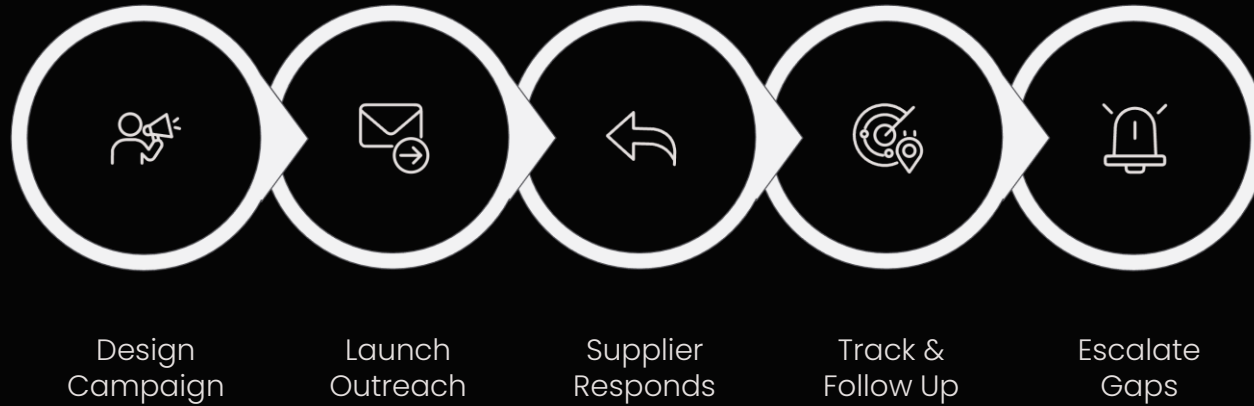
4

Contact & Master Data

Semi-annual

Primary/backup contacts, escalation contacts, portal registration, code of conduct

Step 3: Six-Step Process Flow



Each step has defined owners, timelines, and automated triggers — ensuring zero escalations missed and full audit trail.

Step 1: Design Campaign

Program Manager, Compliance, Sourcing align on scope.

Step 2: Launch Outreach

Send clear instructions, link, and due date.

Step 3: Supplier Responds

Supplier submits data through the defined channel.

Step 4: Track & Follow Up

Monitor progress and send automated reminders.

Step 5: Escalate Gaps

Notify owners and document all actions.

Step 6: Report to Leadership

Share dashboard, trends, escalations, and actions.

Before vs. After: What This Program Eliminates

✗ Before

- Scattered emails from 5 different teams, no tracking
- Manual spreadsheet checks, unknown status
- Missed escalations, no system
- 15% annual contact decay
- 3–4 hours per ad hoc report

✓ After

- Single structured campaign with auto-reminders
- Live tracker, auto-calculated
- REI auto-flags, full audit trail
- 5-step governance, 90% bounce reduction
- One-click monthly dashboard

80%

Less outreach effort

Reduction in manual outreach workload

4–6H

Saved weekly

Time saved on tracking each week

0

Missed escalations

Zero escalations missed

90%

Bounce reduction

Lower bounce rate from improved governance

3–4H

Saved monthly

Time saved on reporting each month

Metrics and Success Criteria

Here's what we measure and how we track success.

Program Success Targets

85%

Response Rate

5 Days

Supplier Speed

95%

Data Accuracy

14 Days

Escalation Time

15%

Data Decay

Monthly Leadership Report

- Overall response rate versus target
- Response by region and tier
- Open escalations
- Data completeness percentage
- Quarter-over-quarter trends
- Recommended actions

About the Author

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12 years Automotive experience

MSCM, University of Michigan Ross 2026

Resources

Operations Tool

10-sheet Excel workbook with 299 live formulas

Live Platform

<https://tejaswismandadi.github.io/Supplier-Comms-Intelligence>

Contact

Live platform:

<https://tejaswismandadi.github.io/Supplier-Comms-Intelligence>

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